

Case Study: Everspring Inn - Unlawful Mass Evictions During the COVID-19 Pandemic Citing just cause evictions. admin closure voluntary compliance.

A City-Sanctioned Humanitarian Crisis

In August 2020, amidst one of the most devastating public health crises in modern history, the tenants of the Everspring Inn at **8201 Aurora Ave N** were forcibly and unlawfully evicted. These were not wealthy tenants with resources to fall back on. These were **the poor, the sick, the elderly—people barely surviving, living month to month in a rundown motel**. And they were **thrown onto the streets with nothing, in the middle of a pandemic**.

This was not just an eviction. This was **state-enabled cruelty** at its most depraved.

The Seattle Police Department had issued a **Chronic Nuisance Property Declaration** to the owner, **Myung Ha Kang (Ryan Kang)**, in an attempt to address ongoing criminal activities at the property. Instead of addressing these concerns, Kang **weaponized** this letter, lied to his tenants, and **claimed the city itself was evicting them**. He used this fabricated justification to **bully them out, lock them out, and leave them to die**.

And the **Seattle Department of Construction and Inspections (SDCI)** **did nothing**.

Chronology of Complaints and SDCI's Failures

August 18, 2020 – A Day of Forced Displacement

13 complaints flooded the SDCI portal on this day. These complaints were. named POTA. COVID 19X.

007153-20CP mass eviction taking place landlord has told tenant need to be out in 24 hrs

<https://services.seattle.gov/portal/customize/LinkToRecord.aspx?altId=007153-20CP>

007155-20CP mass eviction taking place landlord has shut off water, hired security to stop tenants form entering, boarding up windows - everyone need to be out in 24 hrs

<https://services.seattle.gov/portal/customize/LinkToRecord.aspx?altId=007155-20CP>

007158-20CP eviction in place out in 24hrs

<https://services.seattle.gov/portal/customize/LinkToRecord.aspx?altId=007158-20CP>

007159-20CP Unlawful eviction.Lock-out (and common area lock-in)

<https://services.seattle.gov/portal/customize/LinkToRecord.aspx?altId=007159-20CP>

007163-20CP Unlawful eviction

<https://services.seattle.gov/portal/customize/LinkToRecord.aspx?altId=007163-20CP>

007164-20CP

Complaint Outcome: Admin Closure

Resolution Date: Sep 01, 2020 Stella Washington

Alleged Complaint Description: Unlawful eviction

Additional Information: POTA JCEO

<https://services.seattle.gov/portal/customize/LinkToRecord.aspx?altId=007164-20CP>

007175-20CP

Complaint Outcome: Admin Closure -Voluntary compliance

Resolution Date: Sep 01, 2020 Stella Washington

Alleged Complaint Description: eviction notice posted 8/18/2020

Additional Information: POTA JCEO

<https://services.seattle.gov/portal/customize/LinkToRecord.aspx?altId=007175-20CP>

007945-20CP Locked out, door boarded.

<https://services.seattle.gov/portal/customize/LinkToRecord.aspx?altId=007945-20CP>

007946-20CP Boarded room, no hot water

<https://services.seattle.gov/portal/customize/LinkToRecord.aspx?altId=007946-20CP>

007947-20CP Locked out

<https://services.seattle.gov/portal/customize/LinkToRecord.aspx?altId=007947-20CP>

007948-20CP Boarded windows, exit blocked, intimidation

<https://services.seattle.gov/portal/customize/LinkToRecord.aspx?altId=007948-20CP>

007949-20CP In Room. Fenced in area; being told to leave; no hot water; concerned about leaving with Covid-19. Boyfriend is sick and unable to move.

<https://services.seattle.gov/portal/customize/LinkToRecord.aspx?altId=007949-20CP>

008146-20CP HOT WATER OFF DAY AFTER INSPECTION. RIGHTS GUIDANCE
REGARDING ABUSIVE SECURITY STAFF 9/14/2020

<https://services.seattle.gov/portal/customize/LinkToRecord.aspx?altId=008146-20CP>

- **Complaint #007155-20CP:** Tenants reported a **mass eviction in progress**—water shut off, windows boarded up, security guards intimidating and physically removing residents. **SDCI's response?** Marked "Admin Closure" the **same day** with no inspection or follow-up.
- **Complaint #007945-20CP:** Tenants, some already sick, reported being **locked out of their rooms, belongings trapped inside** while they were forced into the streets. **SDCI's response?** "Admin Closure." No investigation.
- **Complaint 007177-20CP**
- **Complaint Outcome: Admin Closure**
- **Resolution Date: Aug 19, 2020 James Hammon**
- Alleged Complaint Description: I am a long term resident at Everspring Inn at 8201 Aurora Ave N. Unit Room 305; Seattle, WA 98103. I moved into Everspring Inn last August, 2019; I pay daily rental fee amount of \$60.00 to secure Room-Unit #305. I pay cash and receive receipts for each payment date. I have rent payment receipts for the

entire year. I have resided at the property ongoing for a continuous period since August 2019. and I receive all postal mail, including bills and bank statements at property. I also was issued a Washington State Driver's License, showing my address as the Everspring Inn, 8201 Aurora Ave N. # 305; Seattle, WA 98103; My WA Driver's License was issued 11/15/2019. In addition to habitable issues of black mold inside the room and common areas, no hot water inside my unit #305, and safety issues. The property manager Ryan Kang verbally threatened and harassed us with eviction and criminal trespass. On or about August 7, 2020; Property Manager-Landlord Ryan Kang, posted a Flyer Notice inside the building common area hallway. The Notice indicated that All residents had to vacate and leave the building. The Notice did not state a date or time to leave, or provide specific information about why residents had to leave. On or about August 8, 2020; the hot water was shut off inside the building and I have been without hot water services since that time. On or about August 11, 2020; Property Manager-Landlord Ryan Kang, posted another Notice demanding that All Residents had to leave the building, since the Seattle Police was coming to close the building; Property Manager threatened us with criminal trespass. Also, Landlord told us that City of Seattle, City Light was coming to cut off the electricity on Tuesday August 18, 2020. On or about August 12, 2020, Landlord Ryan Kang, came to my door with an armed-guard and asked me if they could enter the room for a "look around" I was fearful and only allowed Landlord to enter into the doorway of my room. I suffer from a disability, mental anxiety and depression that I take medication. Seeing the armed guard come with Landlord made me very anxious and apprehensive about my safety. On or about August 13, 2020, Landlord Ryan Kang walked through the building hallway making a verbal announcement that All Residents had to vacate the premises; Landlord further threatened tenant residents by indicating if Residents did not immediately leave the premises, the Seattle police would start making arrests for trespassing on the property. Also, I saw Seattle Police park in front of the Everspring Inn, and remain at the property, but no Police entered the building. On Monday August 17, 2020; I heard property manager announcing that the electricity to the entire building would be shut off on Tuesday, August 18, 2020. I am a disabled senior with no place to live. I consulted with an attorney that I may have rights as a tenant under

the law, since I established my residency staying more than 30 consecutive days at Everspring Inn.

- **Additional Information: JCEO; DUPLICATE 007180-20CP**
- <https://services.seattle.gov/portal/customize/LinkToRecord.aspx?altId=007177-20CP>

Below is the original

- **007180-20CP**
- **Complaint Outcome: Admin Closure -Voluntary compliance**
- **Resolution Date: Sep 01, 2020 Stella Washington**
- Alleged Complaint Description: I am a long term resident at Everspring Inn at 8201 Aurora Ave N. Unit Room 305; Seattle, WA 98103.I moved into Everspring Inn last August, 2019; I pay daily rental fee amount of \$60.00 to secure Room-Unit #305. I pay cash and receive receipts for each payment date. I have rent payment receipts for the entire year. I have resided at the property ongoing for a continuous period since August 2019. and I receive all postal mail, including bills and bank statements at property
- Tenant supplied evidence: <https://tinyurl.com/22rxpcrv>
- Link to SDCI record
- <https://services.seattle.gov/portal/customize/LinkToRecord.aspx?altId=007180-20CP> **She had nowhere to go. She was scared.**
 - **SDCI's response? "Admin Closure."**
 - **What happened to her? No one knows. No one followed up.**
 - **Did she find shelter? Did she survive the pandemic?**

Resolution Failures: How the City Betrayed Its Most Vulnerable

SDCI labeled these complaints as "Voluntary Compliance"—as if the tenants had willingly walked away from their only shelter in the middle of a global pandemic.

They **closed every complaint without an inspection** despite overwhelming evidence of illegal evictions, despite an active eviction moratorium in place, despite the city's legal obligation to protect tenants from predatory landlords.

The SDCI stated JCEO just cause evictions for every single one of these complaints These pleas for help. Please for their lives. Please for their security safety and health. I'm disgusted

These **failures were not just bureaucratic errors**—they were **active choices** that led to **real suffering, real displacement, and very likely real deaths.**

Key Violations and Oversights

● **Eviction Ban Ignored:** At the time, Washington State had implemented a **full eviction moratorium** to prevent mass displacement during COVID-19. SDCI not only failed to enforce this protection but **allowed Kang to lie, manipulate, and illegally force people out.**

● **Pattern of Negligence:** This was not a one-off case. Complaints against this property had been filed **since 2013**. Time and time again, violations were documented, **then ignored**. Notices of Violation (NOVs) were issued, then **never enforced**. This property should have been on the city's highest priority list. Instead, **it was left unchecked.**

● **Permitting Irregularities:** Instead of punishing Kang for repeated violations, the city later **issued him construction permits to convert the motel into a hotel. Let that sink in.** Instead of stopping a man who had thrown sick and elderly tenants into the streets, the city **helped him upgrade his property.**

The Human Toll: The Suffering We Will Never Fully Know

💡 Where did these tenants go? 💡 Who among them survived the pandemic? 💡 How many of them died alone, unhoused, because of this eviction?

The reality is, we **don't know**. There were no follow-ups. No one checked in on the displaced tenants. No city department took responsibility.

But what we **do** know is that these were people who were already living on the brink of survival. The sick. The elderly. The working poor. **People with nowhere else to go.**

And SDCI abandoned them.

This Is Why STLCA Must Exist

This cannot happen again.

◆ **SDCI must be stripped of its power over tenant protections.** ◆ **The Seattle Tenant-Landlord Compliance Authority (STLCA) must take over.** ◆ **We need real oversight, real enforcement, and real accountability.**

This is **not just policy reform**. This is about **stopping government-sanctioned human rights violations**.

● **Seattle must decide: protect tenants or continue enabling corruption.** ●

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April 2021 Department of housing wants permits or SDCI confirmation that Kane can replace windows before authorizing a transient Accommodation's license Lynda Jones refers it to Applicant services on 415.

As of January 21 King still owes \$815 in vacant building monitoring fees.